

How Much Can You Really Make With a Dumpster Rental Business?

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description: Real revenue numbers from real dumpster rental owners. See exactly how much you can make with 7, 21, or 200 dumpsters.

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How Much Can You Really Make With a Dumpster Rental Business?

Let's skip the fluff.

You're either thinking about getting into dumpster rentals, or you're already in it and wondering if you're leaving money on the table. Either way, you want real numbers — not some generic "it depends" answer.

So here's what we're going to do. We're going to break down the actual revenue potential of a dumpster rental business using real data from operators we work with every day. No theory. No "up to" projections. Just math that you can plug your own numbers into.

The Simple Math That Runs This Business

The dumpster rental business comes down to three numbers:

How many dumpsters you have × how fast you rotate them × your price per job = your revenue.

That's it. Everything else — trucks, marketing, employees — is just a cost against that number. So let's break each one down.

What Real Owners Are Actually Charging

Pricing varies by size, region, and whether you're serving residential or commercial customers. Here's what we're seeing across the operators we partner with:

Residential Rentals (weekly)

- 10-14 yard dumpsters: \$350 to \$400
- 15-16 yard dumpsters: \$375 to \$425
- 20 yard dumpsters: \$475 to \$500
- 25 yard dumpsters: \$540 and up

Specialty Dumpsters

- 7 yard (dirt and concrete): \$550 to \$600 flat rate — these are heavy, and operators charge accordingly
- Some operators charge an extra \$250 to \$280 per additional dump if the customer fills it more than once during the rental

Contractor Rates

- Many operators offer discounted rates for contractors who rent for 30 days or more

- The tradeoff: lower per-day revenue, but guaranteed occupancy and zero marketing cost for that unit

The average across most markets lands around \$380 to \$420 per job. Let's use \$400 as our working number.

Scenario 1: Just Starting Out — 7 Dumpsters

You just bought 7 dumpsters. You've got a truck. You're ready to go.

Here's what the math looks like:

Conservative (weekly rotation):

7 dumpsters × 1 job per week each = 7 jobs/week

7 jobs × \$400 = \$2,800/week = roughly \$11,200/month

Aggressive (3-day rotation):

7 dumpsters × 2 jobs per week each = 14 jobs/week

14 jobs × \$400 = \$5,600/week = roughly \$22,400/month

The difference between \$11k and \$22k per month isn't about having more dumpsters. It's about how fast you get them back, cleaned, and out again. Rotation speed is the single biggest lever in this business.

Now subtract your costs — truck payment, fuel, insurance, landfill fees — and you're looking at roughly 40-60% margins depending on your market. That means \$4,500 to \$13,400 per month in profit with just 7 dumpsters.

The catch? If you're just starting, those 7 dumpsters might be sitting in your yard with zero jobs booked. Revenue potential means nothing without customers. We'll come back to that.

Scenario 2: Established Operator — 21 Dumpsters

One operator we work with has 21 dumpsters, two trucks, and a landscaping business on the side. Here's his situation:

- 5-6 dumpsters are locked up with contractors building houses — those won't rotate for months, but they're guaranteed revenue
- About 7 dumpsters sit available for residential and short-term jobs

- 9 more are on order, arriving in 6 weeks

His available inventory does roughly:

7 available dumpsters × 1.5 jobs/week average = 10-11 jobs/week

At \$475 average (he runs 20-yard and 25-yard sizes): roughly \$4,750 to \$5,225/week

That's about \$19,000 to \$21,000 per month from the residential side alone — plus the contractor revenue that's separate.

His problem? One truck stays busy. The second one sits idle most days. That idle truck represents \$8,000 to \$12,000 per month in unrealized revenue. The dumpsters are there. The capacity is there. He just needs more jobs to fill the gaps.

Scenario 3: Scaled Operation — 200 Dumpsters

Now let's look at what's possible when you really scale this thing.

One operator we work with runs 200 dumpsters across two locations — 130 in one city, 70 in another. Ten years in business. Here's what his numbers look like:

- Averaging 190 jobs per month
- Average price: \$380 to \$400 per job
- Monthly revenue: roughly \$72,000 to \$76,000

He's got capacity for more. His goal: add 40 to 50 additional jobs per location per month. If he hits that:

- Additional 80 to 100 jobs/month × \$400 = \$32,000 to \$40,000 in additional monthly revenue

That would put him over \$100,000 per month. And he already has the dumpsters, the trucks, and the team to handle it. He just needs the demand.

The Hidden Revenue Most People Miss

The per-job price isn't the only money coming in. Smart operators build in additional revenue streams:

Overage fees: When a customer goes over the weight limit or keeps the dumpster past the rental period. One operator charges \$270 per extra dump — and most residential customers need at least two dumps before they're done.

Tonnage pass-through: Instead of including dump fees in the price, some operators charge the dumpster rental separately (\$350/week) and pass the tonnage cost directly to the customer. This protects your margin on heavy loads.

Upsells: Customer booked a 14-yard but the job is clearly bigger? That's a natural upsell to a 20-yard at \$100 more.

Multiple dumps per rental: A roofing contractor might fill a 20-yard dumpster three times during a week-long job. That's three dump fees at \$270 each on top of the rental — over \$800 in additional revenue from one customer.

What's Actually Eating Your Profits

Revenue is great, but what matters is what you keep. Here are the real costs:

Landfill fees: This is your biggest variable cost. Rates vary wildly — from \$57 per load (for light loads under 800 pounds) to \$105 per ton plus surcharges in some markets. Know your local rates before you price your services.

Fuel: A roll-off truck isn't exactly a Prius. Budget \$800 to \$1,500 per month per truck depending on how far your jobs are.

Truck payment/maintenance: If you're financing, \$1,500 to \$2,500 per month. If you own outright, budget \$500 to \$800 for maintenance.

Insurance: \$200 to \$500 per month depending on coverage and fleet size.

Marketing: This is where most operators either overspend or underspend. We'll get to that.

The bottom line: Most healthy dumpster rental operations run at 40-60% profit margins. On \$20,000/month in revenue, you should be taking home \$8,000 to \$12,000 after all costs.

The Real Question: Where Do the Jobs Come From?

Here's the thing nobody talks about in the "how much can you make" articles: all of this revenue requires customers.

And getting customers is the hard part — especially when you're competing against established operators who've been building relationships for years.

We've seen operators try every approach:

- **SEO:** Works great, but takes 3 to 6 months to gain traction. That's 3 to 6 months of dumpsters sitting in your yard.
- **Google Ads:** Faster results, but \$15 to \$40 per click in competitive markets. At a 10% conversion rate, you're paying \$150 to \$400 per job in marketing costs.
- **Angi/Thumbtack:** Shared leads that multiple operators are bidding on. The close rate is terrible, and you're paying whether the lead converts or not.
- **Word of mouth:** The best leads, but impossible to scale or predict.

There's another option that's been gaining traction in the industry: the pay-per-job model. Instead of paying monthly retainers or per-click fees, you only pay a success fee when a job is actually completed. Zero upfront risk. No paying for leads that don't convert. Your marketing cost becomes a predictable percentage of revenue, not a gamble.

Run Your Own Numbers

Here's a simple formula to project your revenue:

Monthly Revenue = (Number of Available Dumpsters) × (Jobs per Dumpster per Month) × (Average Price per Job)

Plug in your numbers:

- 7 dumpsters × 6 jobs/month × \$400 = \$16,800/month
- 15 dumpsters × 6 jobs/month × \$400 = \$36,000/month
- 30 dumpsters × 6 jobs/month × \$400 = \$72,000/month

Then subtract roughly 40-50% for costs to get your take-home.

The variable you control most is "jobs per dumpster per month." That number goes up with better marketing, faster rotation, and the right mix of residential and contractor work.

What Should You Do Next?

If you're sitting on dumpsters that aren't earning, every week is money lost. A single idle dumpster at \$400 per job, rotating twice a week, represents \$3,200 per month in missed revenue.

We specialize in helping dumpster rental companies fill those empty slots — and you only pay when the job is done. No retainers. No ad spend. No risk.

Want us to run these numbers for your specific market? Book a free strategy call at dumpsterflow.com and we'll show you exactly what's possible in your area.